

THE MYTHOS MENACE

HOW INDIA CAN PREVENT THE NEW ANTHROPIC AUTONOMOUS AI MODEL FROM DISRUPTING BANKS AND FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE

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IN an old fable from the Arabian Nights, a poor fisherman frees a genie from captivity only to discover the creature may turn on its liberator. Dario Amodei, chief executive of Anthropic, appears determined not to risk a similar fate. Or so goes the modern fable. His company chose not to publicly release 'Mythos', the newest and most powerful model in the Claude family of artificial intelligence (AI) systems, because it was considered too potent for open deployment. Anthropic itself described the model's capabilities as "substantially beyond those of any model we have previously trained".

That alone would have made headlines. But what set off alarm bells globally was what Mythos was built to do. Brewed in the cauldron of agentic AI, especially around coding tasks, it's said to have hyper-evolved into a Frankensteinian monster of sorts, with a transcendent eye for software vulnerabilities, including unknown "zero-day" flaws or bugs unknown to its developer but exploitable by attackers. In short, a capability that could be